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Family

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Definition

- No universal definition
- Four basic criteria go into defining it
  - Marriage and marriage contract
  - Reciprocal economic obligation b/w husband and wife
  - Common residence
  - Rights and duties of parenthood

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Bases of human family

- Human Family has Four bases...
  - Institutional basis
  - Emotional basis
  - Intellectual basis
  - Social basis

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Institutional Basis

- As an institution, family has two types of relationships
  - Family of procreation - Husband & Wife
  - Family of orientation - Children
- Every human family has this duality
- Together, the human family is called a **conjugo-natal family**

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Emotional Basis

- Bonds that brings the people together are outcome of emotions
- Emotions bind members of both conjugal and natal family
- This makes family an **ideal primary group**

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Intellectual Basis

- Manifest / present in the form of rational and reasoned responsibility of members towards each other
- This sense of responsibility guarantees smooth functioning of relationships – consequently the whole society

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Social Basis

- Two facets
  1. Family as a corner stone of the society
  2. As a medium of socialization

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As a corner stone of society

1. Basis of regulation of social life
2. Through family that society ensures a wide range of networks of relationships
3. Nuclear position compared to other groups vis-à-vis society
4. Society manifests at individual level in a family

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Medium of Socialization

1. Family gets the child first – social blank – monopoly – ground work
2. Influence of family – more deeper
3. Ideal primary group
4. No other group satisfies child's needs like it
5. Has both authoritarian and egalitarian relations

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Functions of Family

1. Satisfaction of Sexual need
2. Production and rearing of children
3. Primary socialization
4. Stabilization of adult personality
5. Provision of home
6. Civic functions
7. Economic functions

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Stability & Change of Family

- Family – three connotations
  - Association
  - Institution
  - Process
- Change in all these aspects

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Why Change?

1. Transfer of economic functions from family to outside
2. Diminishing size of the household – only companionship
3. Decline in the number of children – Development of science of contraception – Sex no more a taboo
4. Changes in status of women
5. Shift of emphasis from love and affection to standard of living

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Why Stability?

- Many tempted to say family is diminishing
- But continues to be a universal factor in the society
- Three important functions of family are
  - Sexual
  - Economic
  - Educational

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Stability...

- **Without sex - Man does not live**
- **Without economic cooperation - Life would cease**
- **Without education - No culture**
- Though family does not cater to these exclusively, it has a strategic role to play
- So far, humans have not discovered any viable alternative
- Hence, it continues to be stable and universal

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Typology of Family

- Two basic types
  - Nuclear Family
  - Extended Family
- Nuclear family is organized around conjugal relation
- Extended family is organized around consanguineal relation

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Nuclear Family

- Consists of married couple and their children
- Exists as an isolated / independent unit

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Characteristics

1. Has its own residence, away from the parents of both husband & wife
2. Involvement of parents or kin is marginal (constitutes a separate domestic and economic unit)
3. Larger kin groups are not expected to exercise any control
4. The roles of husband and wife are not rigidly defined
5. Dissolves – divorce or death
6. Dissolution – affects only it but not larger kin groups

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Adaptive Advantage

- Adaptive in many ways to the requirements of an industrialized society or hunting gathering society
- Industrialized societies – Jobs do not depend on familial ties and geographic mobility
- H & G – Allows nomadic tribes to move

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Compound Families

- They are the aggregates of nuclear families liked by common spouse
- **Polygynous and Polyandrous**

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Extended Family

- Also called consanguineal family
- Consists of two or more **lineally related** kin folk of same sex and their spouses and their offspring, occupying a single household of a head
- It is NOT an aggregate of nuclear family, since it is the blood tie that is important than conjugal tie
- It may be organized around either a male or a female
- Patrilineal Extended Family and Matrilineal Extended Family

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Adaptive Advantages

- Highly adaptive in Cultivating societies
- The main advantage is economic
- Large number of workers – good production
- When land is a source of pride – keeps it intact
- More values of companionship
- Sense of dignity and participation
- Affectionate atmosphere for the old

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Impact of Urbanization, Industrialization & Feminism

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Structure of Traditional Family

1. It is the first and foremost association of man
2. Unit of society – not man
3. All the basic requirements are fulfilled by it
4. Power and control over property – male members
5. Joint family system

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Structure of Traditional Family

6. Family traditions – valued above anything
7. Unquestionable authority of family elders
8. Individuals lost their identities in family because it is the unit of all social relation
9. Social environment never provided a chance for an individual to realize whether he had any needs outside the family

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Urbanism

- Urbanism - Three Facets - Political, Ideological and Economic
- The order of the modern day is
  - **Equality** in the political field
  - **Liberalism** in the ideological domain
  - **Capitalism** in the economic domain

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Liberalism as an ideology

- Liberalism has two sentiments
  - Democracy
  - Rationality

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Democracy

- Attacked all the privileges / disabilities based on birth
- Legalized any contract entered by an individual
- Traditional authority systems - challenged
- Respect for the individual – slogan of new era
- Catered for personal opinion, initiative and assertion
- Gave a right to struggle for individual rights
- Economic and political liberties - Domestic Liberty

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Rationalism

- Institutions and traditions – valid only when they are subjected to reason – nothing sacrosanct (sacred) about them
- They can be discarded when they fail the test of reasoning
- Rationalists view traditions as anti-social because they prevent the much required re-adaptation in the changing organism
- Ultimately, rationalism led to emancipation of the individual

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Political Domain

- New civil and criminal laws
- The question of "codes" is now decided by the courts
- The new laws – not acquainted with familial traditions
- Neglected original sources of law
- More secular

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Capitalism

- Generated new economic forces
- **Industrialism**

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Urban Family - Features

1. Changing status of women
2. Lack of traditional education
3. Changing status of individual - vertical social mobility
4. Excess of individuality
5. Limited size
6. Increased rates of divorce
7. Companionship – Family is more a private holding of its members than a collective possession of relatives

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Industrialism

- Factors that affect family

1. Shift from ascription to achievement
2. Social and geographical mobility
3. Creation of formal organizations which cater to individual needs
4. Economic independence

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Impact of Industrialism

1. Traditions – lost
2. Industrial enterprises – little interest in idiosyncrasies and emotional problems of adults and insecurities of children

- But, if family system fails in these matters, there would not be enough people to man industrial organizations!

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Where industrialism failed?

1. Preventing separation and divorce
2. Industrialism demands geographic mobility – ignoring the strains this causes on family
3. Industrialism operates on the fiction that only an individual works in the job – ignoring contributions of the wife / family to a man's productivity
4. It failed to provide an alternative to emotional fluctuations a man faces

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Feminism

- THE CHANGING STATUS
  - A dominant mature feminine role
  - Becoming wage earners – primary
  - Supplementing family income
  - Conjugal roles – becoming increasing joint

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Changing Status & Family

- Shift in traditional division of labor
- Marital adjustment problems
- Children and working mother - lack of attention and improper socialization
- Emotional concerns among children

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